

Git, Part 2: The Humans

Yang et al., "Do Developers Really Know How to Use Git Commands?" TOSEM 2022



Live poll

Guess: the #1 Git question on Stack Overflow?

merge

rebase

revert

push

QR

menti.com · ____

The answer

#1 is git revert.

**4 of the top 5 are about
going back.**

The study

**80,370 Stack Overflow
questions.**

+ a survey of 92 developers.

What they found

- 1 Going back is the #1 pain.
- 2 Even 5-year veterans ask.
- 3 Most people learn Git alone.

Three questions for any study

- 1 Is the question interesting?
- 2 Can the data answer it?
- 3 Do we believe the answer?



Claim Court.

One claim per team. What did they really measure?
Believe it?



Jury vote

Do you believe it? 1–5

1

2

3

4

5

QR

menti.com · ____

Claimed $\neq$ measured

"Experienced" = years on Stack Overflow.

"Difficult" = no accepted answer.



4-minute break

Back at __:__



Design sprint.

Fix one finding. How would you know it worked?

Git listened (2019)

git checkout

→ git switch + git restore



One lesson for designing programming tools?

QR

menti.com · ____

If you remember one thing...

**Question the proxy.
Design the way back.**